

1.6

Requests

- A** Use these beginnings to make indirect questions for situations 1–6 below. Write your questions.

Making a request (to someone else)

Could you possibly ...?
Do you think you could ...?
I'd be grateful if you could ...

Asking for permission (for yourself)

I wonder if I could ...?
Is it all right if we ...?
I wonder if it might be possible to ...?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------|
| 1 Asking a policeman for directions | _____ |
| 2 Customer speaking to supplier | _____ |
| 3 Supplier speaking to customer | _____ |
| 4 Interrupting someone in a meeting | _____ |
| 5 Asking a colleague for a favour | _____ |
| 6 Asking your boss for a big favour | _____ |

- B** Fill in the missing letters in replies 1–5 below. Then put the words in the right order in replies 6–10. Notice that 1–5 are positive replies and 6–10 are negative.

- (Agreeing to a request)** 1 Yes, o__c_____. 2 Yes, cer_____.
(Giving permission) 3 Sure, g__ah_____. 4 Yes, pl____d____. 5 By a__me____s.
6 I'm but sorry busy I'm little right a now. I'm _____
7 I'm afraid working not it's moment at the. I'm _____
8 Well honest be to bit inconvenient it's a. Well, _____
9 I'd didn't you rather actually. I'd _____
10 That's not possible really I'm afraid. That's _____

- C** Work with a new partner. Change roles when you finish.

Student A Make the requests you wrote in section A.

Student B Give positive and negative replies.

Then invent and reply to other requests without using your notes.

- D** Look at these questions with *mind*. Match the first part of the phrase with the last part.

Do you mind if I closing the window?
Would you mind if I closed the window?
Would you mind close the window?

Questions with *mind* mean *Is it a problem for you?* How would you give permission and refuse permission to the question: *Would you mind if I smoked?*

Practise some more examples with *mind*.